

5.7 P2P File Sharing

P2P or Peer-to-Peer software is file-sharing software that has literally shaken up the Internet. If you're looking for a particular type of file, usually a multimedia file, and you know it exists, there's a good chance you'll find it on a P2P network.

In essence, it's basically sharing your resources with other users on the network, so that each node in P2P acts as both a client and a server.

Initially, this concept created quite a furore in the digital entertainment business as it affected the business significantly. Why? No one wanted to buy music anymore. It was available for free! What was happening was that one person who had legally bought a copy of, say, a music album, shared it on a P2P network (mainly Napster in the initial days), and distributed it among millions of users.

A Torrent is a P2P network with better file management and distribution, leading to higher download speeds. Today, there are several P2P software available, but the best ones are the ones that have the maximum number of users, which leads to more sharing of more resources. Here is a look at some of them.

Always remember to respect copyright laws, and to download only non-copyrighted material when using any of the following clients.

Morpheus 5.0

The all-new Morpheus 5.0 is one of the best P2P software available. Powered by the NEOnet network, Morpheus 5.0 comes with a strikingly good interface and a very user-friendly search panel. It utilises the patented 'distributed hash tables' that leads to more relevant searches and faster downloads.

One of the key features of Morpheus is that it searches